

BRIEF - COURSEWORK

Markstrat Performance (30% of coursework)

Companies recognise experienced, effective strategists by their particular style of thinking and decision making. Some of that thinking style can come from reading and by taking part in class discussions, but strategic thinking and decision making only becomes internalised through practice. Business strategy is like flying a plane: to learn it, one must do it.

Your mark will depend on how far your team's stock price index is from the mean stock price within (relative-to-industry-score 50%) and across industries (relative-overall-score 50%).

Markstrat Final Group Report (70% of coursework)

Content and Format:

Write a report on your team's performance in the simulation. Provide a brief justification for your key decisions based on your analysis of the competitive arena and of your team's position within it. The overall purpose of the report is to make visible the rationale behind your decisions and to make appropriate causal attributions between your actions and the outcomes you achieved. Your report may include the following points:

- Reflect on your overall long-term strategy and indicate how successful it was or wasn't.
- What have you learned and why did you achieve this excellent (or poor) performance of your firm.
- What have been key decisions (e.g., product improvements, if and when to enter the Vodite market) and why did they pay off or why did they not pay off?
- Explain actions that went poorly to show an understanding why your performance was not as good as it could have been.

Length:

The report addressing the points above should be a maximum of **2000 words** (double spaced, font size 12), excluding appendices. Cite your sources (bibliography and table of content are not included in the 2000-word limit).

Cover page:

Please create a cover page including a) title b) stream name c) team numbers d) names and e) word count.

Guidance and Marks:

A good report is well-structured, has a clear flow of thought, and explains *why* your team did as well or as poorly as it did. For this portion of your grade, performance does not matter; understanding matters. Your insight is the determinant. Be specific in explaining *HOW* and *WHY* you ended up where you did. If you state that you attempted to increase purchase intentions, state *how* you did so and for what segments. Did you use R&D? Advertising? Sales force? Did it work? You may not have space to talk about all of your brands that you have put on the market neither about all decisions that you have made. That is fine. Focus on those brands and those decisions that you think were key for the performance of your company during the simulation.

An excellent report further includes some analyses based on standard strategy-frameworks you have learned during the ESB programme (e.g., the Boston Consulting Group matrix, first-

mover advantage, SWOT analysis, analysis of cash flow at risk etc.) or some quantitative analysis based on the team's own thinking.

Breakdown of Marks:

- Overall structure, readability, and logical flow (40%)
- Quality of arguments (60%)

Submission Deadline:

One copy should be submitted electronically via Insendi together with a word count by **8th June, 4pm BST.**